

APEX TRUST BANK - STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES (SOP)

Document Type: Banking SOP | Reference: ATB/SOP/OPS/2026-V5

1. Purpose and Standard Operating Protocol

This manual specifies standard branch operational procedures (SOP) across Apex Trust Bank branches, covering cash governance, vault protocol, dormant account lifecycle, and deceased claim settlement.

2. Cash Management & Branch Vault Protocol

- **Dual Custody:** The strong room and vault must be operated under dual custody by the Branch Operations Manager (BOM) and Head Cashier at all times.
- **High-Value Cash Transaction Rules:** Cash deposits exceeding ₹50,000 necessitate mandatory PAN quotation. Cash transactions of ₹10,00,000 and above trigger mandatory source of wealth declaration and automated filing of Cash Transaction Report (CTR) with FIU-IND.
- **Daily Cash Limit & Retention:** Any cash holding in branch vault exceeding the sanctioned retention limit at end of day must be remitted to the Currency Chest by 16:30 hrs.

3. Inoperative & Dormant Account Reactivation SOP

- **Inoperative Classification:** A savings or current bank account is classified as inoperative / dormant if there are no customer-induced financial transactions for a continuous period of **24 months (2 years)**.
- **Reactivation Requirements:** To reactivate a dormant account, the account holder must present in-person with fresh KYC documents (OVD + PAN + recent photograph). Branch staff must verify signatures and complete biometric/face verification.
- **Zero Reactivation Fee:** In accordance with RBI directives, **no fee or penalty can be levied** for reactivating dormant or inoperative accounts.

4. Deceased Depositor Claim Settlement SOP

- **Accounts with Valid Nomination:** Claims with valid nominee registration must be settled within **15 calendar days** of receiving the official death certificate and KYC proof of the nominee, without demanding succession certificate, probate, or letters of administration.
- **Accounts without Nomination (Up to ₹5,00,000):** Settlement is executed in favor of legal heirs against an Indemnity Bond with two independent guarantors, death certificate, and Legal Heirship certificate.

5. Safe Deposit Locker Operation Guidelines

- Access to lockers is permitted only after biometric/signature verification against branch master register.
- Under the revised RBI locker guidelines, the bank's maximum liability for locker contents in instances of burglary, theft, building collapse, or staff fraud is capped at **100 times the annual locker rent**.